This architecture is aimed at companies that want to extract value from data in almost every part of their product and thus build mostly data-intensive applications. Therefore, the primary focus becomes development teams and making their lives a lot easier. This also means that the life of the data engineer is a bit harder or at least will require extra attention.

These are tradeoffs that are hard but necessary. Table 8.4 presents the summary of the Kafka data mesh.

Table 8.4 Kafka architecture profile

Short description	Platform is technologically very centralized. Technologically, getting data into the data product is the responsibility of the data producers.
Pros	Possibility to run most components as a service or self-service. Low maintenance effort of self-serve platform. Native support for development teams. A lot of sources and targets are supported within the ecosystem.
Cons	Extra work necessary to integrate data science and analysis workflows. Strong technological centralization means less autonomy for the development teams. Steep learning curve of using stream processing and Kafka.
Suitable situations	Small- to medium-sized companies focused on building data-heavy applications in most parts of the business.

In this chapter, you explored four architectures and four technology stacks. In the next chapter, we will head into further technical details of data meshes and look at how to migrate from legacy patterns to data mesh patterns.

Summary